

(V1O) Virtual Branding Team

Description & Eligibility

Develop engaging multimedia experiences based on the provided topic. Teams may use Adobe Illustrator®, Adobe Dimension®, Adobe Photoshop®, Adobe Premiere (Rush)® or other software that meets the contest specifications. This national event will be submitted and judged virtually. Awards will be presented at the National Leadership Conference. Any middle level, secondary or postsecondary contestant may enter this event. A team will consist of 2-4 contestants. There are no restrictions on the number of entries per chapter or per state. **Teams who do not submit an entry following the topic listed below or do not follow the Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines will be disqualified.**

Competition Notes

- Contest Registration
 - Advisors register teams for the event using the Membership Registration System, accessible at <https://register.bpa.org>.
 - Click on the “Conferences” tab and then select the “2026 National Virtual Events”.
 - There will be a \$20 fee for each team entry (*invoiced during event registration*).
 - Event registration can be purchased with your original invoice or with a new invoice after member registration.
 - The registration deadline is no later than 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on December 1, 2025.
 - Teams participating in the competition must be registered for the event prior to the submission deadline to be eligible.
 - Only the team captain should complete the submission.

Topic

SolarSip – The Smart, Self-Cooling Water Bottle.

Scenario: Your team has been hired to launch **SolarSip**, an innovative reusable water bottle that uses solar-powered cooling technology to keep drinks cold all day. Your branding campaign should focus on eco-conscious consumers and outdoor enthusiasts.

Deliverables:

- Product line mockups (different colors/styles)
- 30-second digital video ad for social media
- Social media rollout plan targeting Instagram, TikTok, and Facebook

Technical Pre-submit Specifications

What to Submit at https://upload.bpa.org	Saved File Name(s)	Deadline
Clickable URL to Project Files, Works Cited and BPA Release Form(s) in one combined PDF file.	V1O-TeamID.pdf	January 15, 2026, 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time

Contest Competencies

- Demonstrate knowledge of transitions and audio/video editing techniques
- Demonstrate proper use in placement of titles and visual effects
- Demonstrate teamwork skills needed to function in a virtual branding environment
- Develop promotional cross-medium strategy
- Demonstrate awareness of requirements of target audience
- Demonstrate awareness of accessibility concerns
- Demonstrate teamwork skills needed to function in a business setting
- Demonstrate interconnected cross-medium design plan

- Apply principles of design and rules for proper layout in developing business publications for multiple screens and printing situations
- Use principles of design, layout, and typography in media and user experience design
- Demonstrate effective persuasive and informative communication and presentation skills

Contest Specifications for this Event

- Submit the URL to the final Project Files including Clickable **URL** to Project Files, along with the Works Cited and BPA Release Form(s) in a combined PDF file to <https://upload.bpa.org> no later than **11:59 p.m. Eastern Time, on January 15, 2026**.
- An auto-generated confirmation will be provided upon project submission for the National Leadership Conference; individual confirmation cannot be provided. **No changes can be made to the project after the date of submission.**
- Advisors of qualifying teams will be contacted to reserve a time for a videoconference presentation before a panel of judges. The dates and times for presentation reservations will be announced via email notification. Teams will be assigned to sections prior to the preliminary presentation.
- Length of event: no more than three (3) minutes for setup, no more than ten (10) minutes for the presentation, and no more than five (5) minutes for judges' questions.
- Teams with the highest cumulative technical and presentation scores will be invited to attend the National Leadership Conference to be recognized for their outstanding efforts and to participate in the National Showcase. See <https://bpa.org/nlc/virtual-competitions-and-nlc-national-showcase/> for more information.

Common Specifications for all BPA Judged Events

- Team ID is required for all submissions. Materials from non-registered members and/or those missing team ID cannot be accepted.
- The team is responsible for securing a BPA Release Form(s) from any person, including themselves, whose image or work is used in the project.
- The team is responsible for citing all sources, including themselves, on the Works Cited page for any work used on the project. It is the policy of Business Professionals of America to comply with copyright law. The *Style & Reference Manual* contains guidelines for Copyright and/or Fair Use. Contestants will be disqualified for violations of the guidelines.
- Materials must follow the organization's BPA Graphic Standards and make proper use of the BPA logo and/or organization's name. Refer to the BPA Graphic Standards in the *Style & Reference Manual*.
- Judges' comments will be returned digitally through the online judging system at the national level. Materials submitted for technical judging will *not* be returned and will *not* be available at NLC.

This event is sponsored by:



(V10) Virtual Branding Team

Technical Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Submission and Formatting (All points or none are awarded by the technical judge)				
Team submitted one (1) combined PDF file containing URL link to Project Files, one (1) Design Overview, Works Cited formatted according to the <i>Style & Reference Manual</i> and BPA Release Form(s).				/10
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Content Quality	The content is unclear, lacks coherence, contains inaccuracies, or is too shallow or unfocused to support the message.	The content is clear, mostly accurate, relevant, and demonstrates adequate depth and organization.	The content is well-structured, highly accurate, relevant, and reflects strong depth and breadth of understanding.	/20
Technical Execution	Execution is inconsistent or disorganized, with limited use of appropriate tools and weak technical proficiency.	Execution is competent and organized, with appropriate use of tools and solid technical skills.	Execution is highly proficient, well-structured, and demonstrates expert use of tools and resources to enhance the presentation.	/20
Creativity & Originality	The content lacks originality, relies heavily on conventional ideas, and shows minimal creative effort.	The content includes some original ideas and demonstrates a thoughtful, creative approach.	The content is highly original, innovative, and showcases distinctive thinking and a fresh, engaging perspective.	/20
Audience Impact	The presentation lacks engagement, fails to resonate with the audience, and shows minimal persuasive impact.	The presentation is engaging and relevant, with a reasonable ability to persuade and connect with the audience.	The presentation is captivating, highly persuasive, and powerfully resonates with the target audience, inspiring interest or action.	/20
Technology Integration	Technology use is minimal, outdated, or poorly implemented, leading to a disjointed or ineffective experience.	Technology is appropriately integrated, functional, and contributes positively to the presentation.	Technology is seamlessly embedded, utilizes cutting-edge tools, and creates an engaging, intuitive user experience.	/20
Writing Accuracy	Frequent grammar or spelling errors.	Contains some grammar or spelling errors.	Contains very few or no grammar or spelling errors.	/20
30-Second Advertisement Video	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Creativity of Concept	The concept lacks originality or fails to engage the viewer with a clear or compelling idea.	The concept is creative and effectively communicates the intended message in a clear and engaging way.	The concept is highly original, memorable, and demonstrates exceptional creativity in delivering the message.	/20

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Con't)

Clarity of Messaging for Target Audience	The message is unclear or poorly aligned with the intended audience, making it difficult to understand or connect with.	The message is clear and appropriately tailored to the target audience, effectively conveying the intended idea.	The message is exceptionally clear, compelling, and precisely crafted to resonate with the target audience.	/20
Social Media Graphics	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Visual Appeal	The design lacks cohesion or aesthetic quality, making it visually unengaging or distracting.	The design is visually appealing, well-organized, and enhances the message without overpowering it.	The design is striking, polished, and creatively enhances the message with strong visual impact.	/20
Graphic Effectiveness	Graphics do not clearly support the message or lack impact, making the content feel disconnected or ineffective.	Graphics effectively support and enhance the message, with appropriate use of motion and static elements.	Graphics are highly effective, seamlessly integrated, and elevate the message through creative and purposeful design.	/20
Branding Consistency	Brand elements are used inconsistently, weakening the overall identity and message.	Brand elements are consistently applied, maintaining a cohesive and recognizable identity.	Branding is flawlessly consistent and reinforces a strong, unified identity across all visuals.	/20
Promotional Flyer	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Design & Layout	The flyer is cluttered or poorly organized, making it hard to follow or visually unappealing.	The flyer is well-organized and visually balanced, supporting readability and appeal.	The flyer is exceptionally well-designed, with a polished layout that enhances impact.	/20
Clarity & Quality of Information	Information is unclear, incomplete, or not relevant to the flyer's purpose.	Information is clear, accurate, and appropriately detailed for the flyer's purpose.	Information is highly clear, compelling, and expertly tailored to the flyer's goals.	/20
Team Decision-Making (One-Page Overview)	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Branding Clarity (Colors & Fonts)	Branding choices are inconsistent or unclear, making the visual identity feel disjointed.	Branding choices are clear and consistent, supporting a cohesive visual identity.	Branding choices are highly intentional, visually cohesive, and reinforce brand identity.	/20
Decision-Making Clarity	The process is vague or poorly explained, making it hard to understand how decisions were made.	The process is clearly outlined and shows logical steps in team decision-making.	The process is exceptionally clear, well-structured, and demonstrates thoughtful collaboration.	/20
Event Webpage Prototype	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 15-20 points	Points Awarded
Visual Layout	Layout is cluttered or disorganized, making the page hard to navigate or understand.	Layout is clean and organized, supporting readability and user experience.	Layout is highly polished, intuitive, and enhances the overall user experience.	/20

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Technical Scoring Rubric (Con't)

Branding Consistency	Branding elements are inconsistent or poorly applied across the webpage.	Branding is consistently applied, maintaining a cohesive visual identity.	Branding is seamlessly integrated and reinforces a strong, unified identity.	/20
Content Structure	Information is scattered or lacks logical flow, making it hard to follow.	Content is well-structured and logically organized for clarity and ease of use.	Content is expertly structured, guiding the user smoothly through the information.	/20
Navigation Design	Navigation is confusing or incomplete, making it difficult to move through the site.	Navigation is clear and functional, allowing users to easily access key sections.	Navigation is intuitive, user-friendly, and enhances the overall site experience.	/20
Visual Appeal	Design lacks aesthetic quality or feels outdated and unengaging.	Design is visually appealing and supports the content effectively.	Design is striking, modern, and enhances engagement through strong visual elements.	/20
TOTAL TECHNICAL POINTS				/40

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Presentation Scoring Rubric

Required Elements (If any question results in a NO, please assign a score of 0)				
Team followed the topic.				☐ Y ☐ N
Team followed Copyright and/or Fair Use Guidelines.				☐ Y ☐ N
If answered no to either question, please stop scoring and provide a brief reason for the <i>disqualification</i> :				
Evaluation Criteria	Below Expectations 0-9 points	Meets Expectations 10-15 points	Above Expectations 16-20 points	Points Awarded
Presentation	Team struggles with communication, organization, or topic understanding, making the presentation unclear or disengaging.	Team communicates clearly, stays organized, and demonstrates solid understanding of the topic.	Team excels in delivery, presents with clarity and enthusiasm, and shows deep understanding of the topic.	/20
Explanation of Project Phases	Explanation of pre-production, production, and post-production is unclear or incomplete.	Clearly explains each phase of the project with relevant details.	Thoroughly explains all phases with insight and strong connection to project goals.	/20
Technology & Software Use	Tools and software used are not clearly identified or explained.	Provides a clear explanation of the technology and software used in the project.	Offers detailed and thoughtful explanation of tools, showing strong understanding.	/20
Team Roles	Roles of team members are vague or missing, with little connection to project outcomes.	Clearly explains the roles and contributions of each team member.	Provides a comprehensive and engaging explanation of team roles and collaboration.	/20
Structure & Flow of Presentation	Presentation lacks organization and is difficult to follow.	Presentation is well organized and flows logically.	Presentation is highly engaging, with excellent structure and smooth transitions.	/20
Judges' Questions	Responses lack depth and fail to demonstrate a comprehensive understanding of the topic.	Some responses lack detail or clarity. The understanding of the topic is partially demonstrated.	Responses are detailed, insightful, and effectively address the judges' questions.	/20
Team Members	At least two original team members were present during the presentation.			/5
Timing	Set-up lasted no longer than three (3) minutes, and the presentation lasted no more than ten (10) minutes.			/10
TOTAL PRESENTATION POINTS				/135

Props and/or additional items shall not be used as a basis for scoring.

PRESENTATION WILL BE STOPPED AT TEN (10) MINUTES